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Teachers union teams with firefighters to amp up pressure in battles for labor contracts. **Chicagoland, Page 3**

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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

WASHINGTON

Trump: Musk not in on China plan

Amid backlash, Tesla used car market slumping in Chicago

By Robert Channick
Chicago Tribune

With anecdotes of owners trading in their Teslas amid backlash over CEO Elon Musk's unelected role as agency dismantler-in-chief for Trump 2.0, don't be surprised to see a few more of the EVs parked under giant tube men at Chicago-area used car lots this spring.

The number of used Teslas for sale in the Chicago area is up 1% in March year-over-year, bucking an overall trend that saw inventory decline by 6.3%, according to used car shopping website iSeeCars. At the same time, used Tesla prices are dropping faster than any other brand, and demand is slumping.

While it is too early to say that Teslas are flooding the used car market, there are signs that a growing number of owners may be pulling the plug in Chicago and across the U.S.

Turn to Tesla, Page 2



A 2017 Tesla Model S is charged at Driven Auto Sales in southwest suburban Burbank on Friday. The average used Tesla price dropped 13.6% year-over-year in February, more than any other brand. **AUDREY RICHARDSON/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Billionaire's Pentagon visit for efficiency talks, Hegseth says

By Tara Copp
Associated Press

WASHINGTON — President Donald Trump said Friday that war plans should not be shared with his adviser Elon Musk because of his business interests, a rare suggestion that the billionaire entrepreneur's expansive role in the administration will face limits.

Trump made the comments during an Oval Office meeting on developing a new fighter jet, and he rejected reports that Musk would be briefed on how the United States would fight a hypothetical war with China.

"Elon has businesses in China," the Republican president said. "And he would be susceptible, perhaps, to that."

Trump praised Musk as a patriot. However, the reference to his businesses — which include Tesla, an electric vehicle manufacturer trying to expand sales and

Turn to Musk, Page 6

The roofs are caving in, a pedestrian bridge is closed and the grist mill has boards across the entryway. But now efforts are underway to restore a crumbling site where Abraham Lincoln began his political rise



An Abraham Lincoln statue is seen during a tour on March 10 with volunteers and elected officials at Lincoln's New Salem State Historic Site. **ANTONIO PEREZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

'WE'VE GOT TO PROTECT IT'

By Addison Wright | Chicago Tribune

In 1831, Abraham Lincoln arrived at the New Salem grist mill along the Sangamon River aboard a flatboat that was sinking.

Lincoln had been hired by a man named Denton Offutt to deliver the boat cargo to New Orleans. As the story goes, Offutt was so impressed by Lincoln's quick thinking to rescue the boat and save the cargo that he offered him a job at a shop he planned to open in New Salem. Lincoln returned from the cargo trip and decided to stay in New Salem, about 20 miles northwest of Springfield.

By the time Lincoln left the town in 1837, he was a state legislator and his political career was taking off. While New Salem was essentially abandoned in the years after Lincoln departed for Springfield and then Washington, D.C., it was reconstructed during the 1930s as an historic site that last year attracted almost 400,000 visitors.

But time has taken a toll on the state's effort to memorialize Lincoln in the town where he developed his political chops.

Lincoln's New Salem State Historic Site has fallen into disrepair as the tab for deferred maintenance on properties managed by the Illinois Department of Natural Resources has grown to an estimated \$1 billion statewide, according to IDNR spokesperson Jayette Bolinski.

In recent years, the roofs of two structures have caved in. The grist mill, where townspeople would grind wheat into flour, is closed, with boards across the entryway. There are holes in the wooden entrance ramp, and the mill's drive shaft, which powered the structure, has been inoperable since a 2016 flood.

Gina Gillmore-Wolter, president of the New Salem Lincoln League, said it's unsafe for schoolchildren to walk along the road, or over the closed pedestrian bridge, to reach the mill.

When responsibility for the site, along with all other state historic sites, was shifted to IDNR

Turn to Lincoln, Page 4

TODAY'S
WEATHER



High 43 Low 32

Complete Chicagoland forecast on Page 8

\$4.00 city and suburbs and elsewhere
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